

☑ Boot Up Floppy Seek

Disable this option. When it's enabled, your system spends a few extra seconds looking for your floppy drive, a relatively pointless procedure, especially considering how infrequently you use your floppy drive.

☑ Boot Delay

Some systems let you delay booting after you turn on your PC so that your hard drive gets a chance to start spinning before bootup. Most likely, you don't need to have this boot delay, so turn it off. If you run into problems, however, you can always turn it back on again.

Fine-Tune Your Registry For Faster Startups

 Over time, your Registry can turn bloated with unused entries, slowing down your system startup because your system loads them every time you start up your PC. Get a Registry clean-up tool to delete unneeded Registry entries and speed up startup times.

After you clean out your Registry, you might want to try compacting it to get rid of unused space.

Shutting Down Faster

 For security reasons, you can have XP clear your paging file (pagefile.sys) of its contents whenever you shut down. Your paging file is used to store temporary files and data, but when your system shuts down, information stays in the file. Some people prefer to have the paging file cleared at shutdown because sensitive information, such as unencrypted passwords, sometimes ends up in the file. However, clearing the paging file can slow shutdown times significantly, so if extreme security isn't a high priority, you might not want to clear it.

To shut down XP without clearing your paging file, run the Registry Editor and go to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Session Manager\Memory Management. Change the value of

ClearPageFileAtShutdown to "0". Exit the Registry Editor and restart your computer.

Whenever you turn off XP from now on, the paging file won't be cleared, and you should be able to shut down more quickly.

Windows Keyboard Shortcuts

You know of the obvious keyboard shortcuts, such as [Ctrl] + [V], and [Alt] + [Tab]. You probably don't know them all, however. Experiment with them all - most of them which we've listed here - and see which ones you'd like to adopt!

[Windows] + [E] opens My Computer in Windows Explorer

[Windows] + [Pause/Break] opens the System Properties dialog box

[Windows] + [U] opens the Utility Manager

[Windows] + [R] opens the 'Run...' prompt

[Windows] + [F] opens the 'Search for Files and Folders' window

[Windows] + [Ctrl] + [F] opens the 'Search for computers on the network' window

[Windows] + [M] minimises all windows

[Windows] + [Shift] + [M] maximises all windows (after you've minimised them)

[Windows] + [D] minimises all windows to the desktop, and then restores all Windows

[Windows] + [L] locks the computer

[Windows] + [B] selects the first item in the System Tray; use the arrow keys to cycle through the items and use [Enter] to open a selected item in the System Tray

[Alt] + [Enter] opens the 'Properties' page of a selected item

[Alt] + [Esc] cycles between open programs in the order they were opened

[Alt] + [Spacebar]: in the active window, this brings up the corner dialog box for Move, Size, Minimize, Maximize, or Close

[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Esc] Opens the Windows Task

The accessibility options will let you customise how your keyboard behaves when certain keys are pressed



Manager

[F2] will rename an item

[F3] opens the 'Search for files and folders' window

[F6] cycles through the different types of elements that can be selections on a screen or window

[F10] selects the menu bar in the active program (usually 'File') so you can use the arrow keys to navigate through the menus and [Enter] to select

[Shift] + [F10]: for a selected item, this does the same thing as a right-click with the mouse

[Ctrl] + [Esc] opens the Start Menu

Clicking [Shift] five times turns StickyKeys On or Off
Holding down the right [Shift] for eight seconds turns FilterKeys On or Off

Holding down [Num Lock] for five seconds turns ToggleKeys On or Off

StickyKeys, FilterKeys, ToggleKeys

 **StickyKeys:** This feature changes the way modifier keys work. Normally, keys like [Shift] and [Ctrl] are only 'active' while they're held down. When you release them the system forgets they were ever pressed. This causes problems for some users who can't, for example, hold down three keys at once to enter certain combinations like [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Tab].

When enabled, this function causes modifier keys to 'stick' until they are either manually released, or until a keystroke combination is complete. In other words, it makes modifier keys behave more like locking ones. There are a number of settings to allow options like confirmation sounds, to automatically turn it off when no longer needed, and so on.

FilterKeys: This feature can be considered the opposite of the typematic feature; it causes Windows to suppress or ignore bursts of keystrokes that are sent too quickly - either fast streams of the same key or clumps of different keys sent all at once. Such bursts might, for example, be made by someone who does not have perfect control of his or her fingers due to a tremor. A number of settings let you control how long a key must be held down for it to register, set audible confirmations and other options.

ToggleKeys: This feature causes Windows to provide an audible indication when any of the permanent (locking) modifier keys is pressed. In essence, this is like an audible version of the indicator LEDs on the keyboard. ☑